

PTAB Meeting Minutes: March 19, 2025

Present: Colleen O'Neill, Stacy Allott, Doug Haney, Jimmy Cunningham, Julianne Stemp, Ezra Schwartzberg, Bayle Reichert (Village Employee), Aurora White (Village Trustee)

1. Approve February Meeting Minutes: Motion by Ezra, Second by Jimmy

2. Unfinished Business:

- **Sidewalk Assessment:** Ezra and Stacy. Presented findings, chose short list of priority sidewalks based on most problems, and mapped the locations. Church Street wasn't assessed. Woodruff needs a lot of work but is part of a bigger project so it was omitted from priority list but will still be noted to DPW. PTAB to send edits to Ezra ASAP so we can submit the list to DPW.
- **2025 Goals and Initiatives:**
 - **Community Bike Ride:** Doug and Julianne. Planning about 6 rides this season focused on family and youth. Coincide with Music on the Green and Berkeley Green movie nights. Bayle said that ROOST can create marketing materials, banners and social media ads as part of their contract with Saranac Lake. Signage; consider keeping existing sign or replace with a changeable tack board to promote rides in Berkeley Green and a sign at the Depot which is where rides will originate. Need facilitators/guides to volunteer to lead a ride, Justin at Silver Birch expressed interest in getting involved in the program. Consider more bike racks for Riverside Park.
 - **Lake Colby:** Ashley and Steve. Not present, no update.
 - **Expand Pollinator Habitats and Climate Planning:** Steve. Not present, no update.
 - **Riverside Park Bandshell:** Jimmy and Stacy. Bayle said funding may be available through a grant, she will check with Melissa McManus. Tupper Lake is an exemplary bandshell and Stacy can reach out to Andrew the builder for more info and an estimate once Bayle updates us first. Other Village Advisory Boards will provide feedback once we're further along.
 - **Children's Park Equipment:** Ashley. Not present, no update.
 - **Rail Trail Connections and Crossings:** Colleen and Doug. Spoke with DEC about wayfinding signage in their last phase of construction. They are seeking a consultant to create the signs and expect to contract in Fall. Kendra Ormerod DEC will then reach out to us to collaborate on the signage to include downtown amenities, and Saranac Lake history. Village hired a consultant to review Rail Trail crossings within the Village and make safety recommendations; report generated June 2024. Colleen to check with Katrina on the status of improvements. We have some existing road safety bollards, ask

DPW to put them up for the season. Fowler's Crossing is still a concern; DOT rejected speed limit decrease and said they needed more data to make any other decisions on modifications. DEC just released trail counter data from Pine Street, we could bring up that we have data and ask if they have collected any data. Usage is high and laser counter sometimes misses, so actual numbers are higher. Colleen and Doug to connect with Aurora on the best way to handle DOT follow up as the original communication came from the Village.

- **Comprehensive Recreation Plan for Mount Pisgah:** Ezra, Steve, Julianne, Doug. BETA hired a consultant to review trails and make recommendations on improvements to existing trails, not new ones. There is a series of partner and stakeholder meetings beginning on April 6 and into May to discuss issues, trail planning, design, and community objectives. Doug to keep PTAB updated on the meetings.
- **Recycling Program:** Doug. Waiting to hear back from Bachana and John to see if the Village is supportive of us pursuing before we research, get estimates and best practices. Aurora to set a meeting up with Doug, Bachana and John.
- **Park Updates:**
 - **Baldwin Park:** Kick off meeting to happen next week with consultants from La Bella.
 - **Garwood POW Park:** Meeting next week to determine next steps. Pursuing a CFA grant and looking into accessibility planning.
 - **Ward Plumadore:** Mountainscape is moving forward, Village contracting with Dan King and arranging first payment to order materials.
 - **Boothe River Park:** Critical action items during this phase, including easements, FERC licensing, and funding. Colleen to connect Scott McKim and Aurora re: the project.

3. New Business:

- **Park Maintenance Program:** Members chose a park to review. Start in April once things have thawed and aim to be done in May, before our 5/21 meeting to review then submit to DPW.
- **Capital Improvement Plan:** Public information session held and Committee is gathering findings to present to the Village in May. Charlotte Lomino is staying on the planning committee until they complete their findings in May. Village takes it over and begins to implement it. It will assist with planning, funding, ranking/priorities, and timelines for projects across the Village, including PTAB's.

4. Adjourn at 7:30 p.m.: Motion by Ezra, Second by Jimmy